

NEMA Disaster Ready Fund: Remote Community Resilience

1. Program Overview

- **Funding Agency:** National Emergency Management Agency (NEMA)
 - **Program Name:** Disaster Ready Fund (DRF) - Remote Community Resilience Program
 - **Goal:** To build disaster resilience in remote regional communities by funding structural retrofitting of community buildings, emergency communications installations, and local hazard mitigation (floods, extreme heat, bushfires).
 - **Funding Value:** Grants between \$200,000 and \$1,000,000.
 - **Duration:** Projects must be completed within 18 months of funding agreement execution.
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2. Funding Focus Areas

- **Emergency Shelter & Service Retrofitting:** Structural reinforcing of primary clinics or community hubs to serve as extreme weather shelters. Includes cooling insulation, storm shutters, and floor level raises in flood zones.
 - **Redundant Communications:** Installation of satellite internet (Starlink), satellite phones, and backup radio transceivers to ensure communications remain operational when fiber optic or cellular networks fail during disasters.
 - **Emergency Water and Power Storage:** Installation of dedicated emergency water reserves (tanks) and backup power systems (generators/solar) to support isolated townships for up to 7 days.
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3. Application Response Requirements

Written applications must answer the following selection criteria:

Criteria A: Hazard Exposure & Vulnerability Assessment (Weight: 40%)

- *Prompt:* Detail the specific disaster hazards that threaten your community (e.g. road cuts due to flooding Sandover Hwy, extreme summer heatwaves up to 48°C, grid blackouts). How does

this vulnerability affect critical health service delivery to community members, and how does the project address this vulnerability?

- *Key Information Required:* Risk history, outstation isolation stats, climate vulnerability details.

Criteria B: Resilience Infrastructure & Redundancy Design (Weight: 30%)

- *Prompt:* Explain the technical design of the proposed resilience infrastructure. How does the system ensure redundancy (e.g., dual satellite links, dual water pumps, automated battery backups)? Describe how the retrofitted facilities will operate during a major disaster event.
- *Key Information Required:* Engineering layout, redundancy specs (satellite failover, backup power circuits).

Criteria C: Community Response & Operational Preparedness (Weight: 30%)

- *Prompt:* Outline how the community and health service staff will be trained to use the emergency systems. Detail your local disaster response plan, coordination with NT Emergency Services (PFES), and how the project will maintain operational readiness outside of emergency events.
- *Key Information Required:* Staff training schedule, local emergency mock drill plans, maintenance checks log.